MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume VIII | Issue 1 | Winter 2018

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MOVIE THEATERS of the SOUTH BAY & PENINSULA

STARRING Local Author & Theatre Historian GARY LEE PARKS

Presented by the MTN. VIEW HISTORICAL ASSC.

SUNDAY, FEB. 11, 2018, 1:00 PM at the ADOBE BLDG.

See page 4 for more info!

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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News & Notes

President's Message

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President



MVHA President Candace Bowers at the Adobe Building during the MVHA's 2nd annual Dia de los Muertos event.

Happy New Year!

I've heard so many people say they're glad that 2017 is over. We've certainly seen some, shall we say, "interesting" developments on the local, national, and international levels. Our world can feel even more divided and confusing than ever; the future, even more uncertain.

Silicon Valley (or as some of us prefer to call it, the Valley of Heart's Delight) has been called a "bubble." The Bay Area—and, let's face it, California in general—has been accused of being out of touch with the rest of the country. To me, that has always meant that we were so fortunate to live in such a great place that we sometimes failed to realize that other people… didn't. But in recent years, reality has hit us right where we live. We've seen beloved landmarks torn down or paved over; favorite businesses have disappeared seemingly overnight; and the neighbors who used to lend us a cup of sugar have moved away and been replaced by a rotating cast of Airbnb guests. The change can be both exhilarating and disorienting. I've felt both!

We, the members of the MVHA, have a special role in this changing landscape. Yes, we love to reminisce about the good old days. We value our past. But let's not get too stuck living there—let's share it in a positive way! We love to share our memories, to spread our knowledge. Let's make sure that the best parts of "good old" Mountain View carry over into great, new Mountain View.

See you at the Adobe!

—Candace

P.S. I hope you all look forward to getting this newsletter in your mailbox (and I mean your actual, physical, US mailbox.) I still love to get paper magazines and catalogs in the mail, even though I live my life on the computer and have delegated everything I can think of to my various tech gadgets. But just in case you're feeling a bit left behind as technology takes over the world, please remember that our Library and Senior Center have free public computers, and people who can show you how to use them. Curious about the MVHA's website or Facebook page, but not sure how/where to find them? Visit me in the History Center and I'll show you.

Financial Report

By Emily Ramos
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 9/19/2017: $30,102.68
- Income: $224.40
- Expenses: $561.54

Checking Account Balance as of 1/19/2018: $29,765.54

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 9/19/2017: $59,958.66
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 1/19/2018: $60,028.90

Villa St. Properties: Update

By Alison Hicks
Director-at-Large

In a surprise decision early last month, Councilmember John McAlister saved the Weilheimer House and Tied House from imminent destruction or removal from their historic site on Villa Street . The buildings are listed on the city's historic register as two of downtown Mountain View's significant cultural resources.

At a packed study session Nov. 28, dozens of residents urged council to preserve the buildings. The group Livable Mountain View turned in petitions with over 2,500 signatures urging the city to save the buildings in place. Ultimately a bare majority of four council members, including McAlister, voted to replace the buildings with a four-story office building and restaurant. Mayor Rosenberg and Councilmembers Matichak and Abe-Koga voted to save the two buildings in place, while the rest of council voted in favor of removal.

At a little-attended council meeting a week later, Councilmember McAlister announced that he would employ a rarely used council option to change his vote within the week, thus reversing the majority vote to favor saving the buildings.

Most people learned about the surprise change when they read about it in the *Mtn. View Voice*. Public comments generally supported the decision. Adrian McCombie said, "My father put his soul into making Chez TJ thrive. Thank you for saving a little piece of Chef Thomas J. McCombie." And Jerry Steach commented, "Bravo, Councilwomen Abe-Koga and Matichack, Mayor Rosenberg, and now Councilman McAlister for the vision and courage you're demonstrating in support of Downtown Mountain View's character, historic resources and continued vitality!"

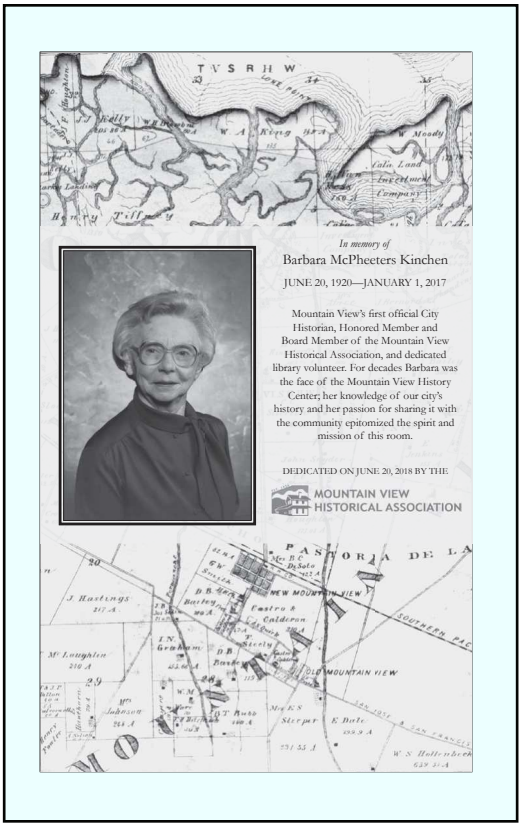
MVHA Board Updates

By Nick Perry
MVHA Vice President

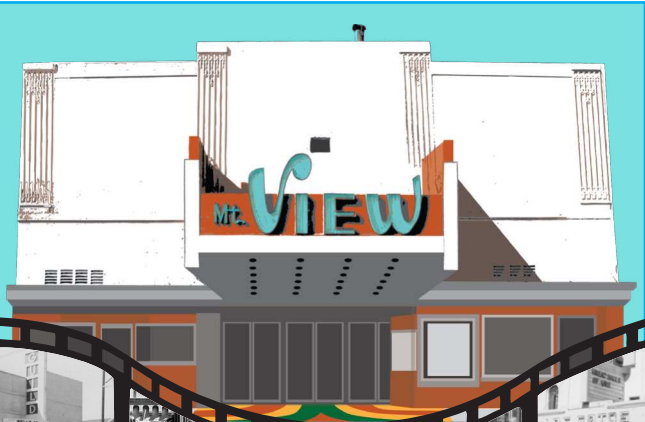
A few miscellaneous updates from the last MVHA Board of Directors Meeting:

- **Board Changes.** Annemarie Montavon ha**s** resigned from her position as Director-at-Large to focus on other priorities. We thank her for her service! The Director-at-Large position is a very flexible position and is a great way to get involved! Please contact any Board member if you are interested or have any questions.

- **Barbara Kinchen Memorial Plaque.** Plans are moving forward for a plaque honoring our late City Historian and MVHA Board Member Barbara Kinchen. Our goal is to have the plaque manufactured as soon as possible with an official dedication ceremony on Barbara's birthday, June 20 . We've contacted a manufacturer and are in the process of finalizing the design. The proposed plaque would be etched stainless steel on a glass backing. In memory of Barbara's love of Mtn. View's history, the new design features a historic map of Mountain View lightly etched in the background. The latest mock-up is shown below.



Winter 2018 Event Preview





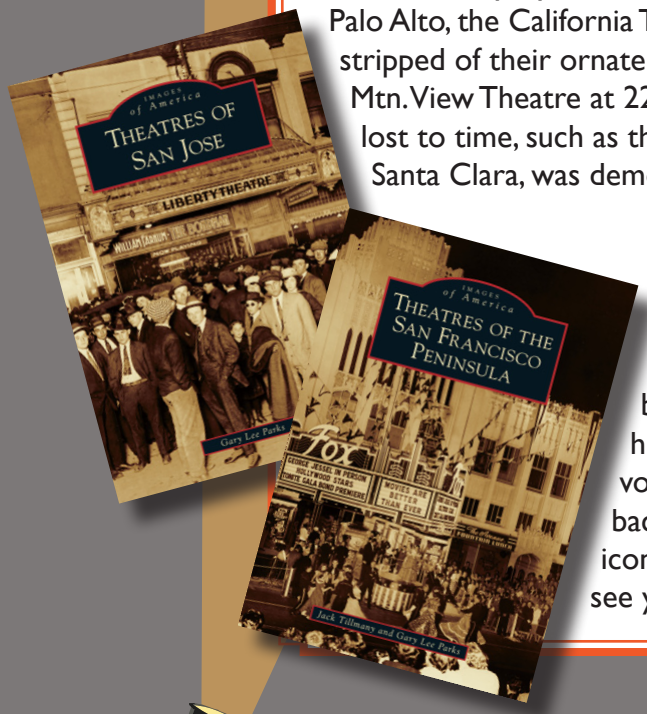
MOVIE THEATERS *of the* SOUTH BAY & PENINSULA

SUNDAY FEB. 11, 2018 AT 1:00-3:00 PM

FREE
For **MVHA** *Members*
$5 Suggested Donation at-the-door for non-members

There's no place quite like a classic movie theater. The neon glow of a bright marquee lighting up a downtown street. Colorful terrazzo paving beckoning you toward the front door. The smell of fresh popcorn and the sounds of a Wurlitzer pipe organ filling the air. Plush velvet seats beneath a soaring auditorium ceiling. The curtains draw, and the show begins .

For decades, the downtowns of almost every city from San Jose to San Francisco featured at least one movie theater. Some still evoke the glory of their heyday: The Fox Theatre in Redwood City, the Stanford Theatre in Palo Alto, the California Theatre in San Jose. Others still stand, but have been stripped of their ornate architecture and iconic signage, like our very own Mtn. View Theatre at 226 Castro Street. Still others have been completely lost to time, such as the Santa Clara Theatre, which, like all of Downtown Santa Clara, was demolished in the 1960s.



At our winter event, we invite you to join us as Gary Lee Parks, author of Theatres of San Jose and coauthor of Theatres of the San Francisco Peninsula, shares the story of our local movie theater buildings. Mr. Parks has assisted in the preservation of historic Bay Area theaters as both a professional and a volunteer. His slideshow lecture well draw the curtains back and reveal the fascinating stories behind these iconic buildings. And yes, there will be popcorn! Hope to see you there!

Historic Adobe Building
157 MOFFETT BLVD., MTN. VIEW, CA
RSVP BY VISITING WWW.MVHISTORY.EVENTBRITE.COM

Fall 2017 Event Recap



On November 5, 2017, the MVHA hosted its second annual Mtn. View Dia de los Muertos celebration. A short presentation on the history of Pioneer Memorial Park by MVHA President Candace Bowers kicked off the event. Soon after, the Adobe Building was filled with the sights and sounds of traditional Mexican dance and music thanks to the talented performances of Raices de Mexico and Mariachi Tapatio. In addition to celebrating Mtn. View's historic Mexican roots and culture, the event was also a chance to honor the lives of those who have passed away and reflect on our shared history.



MVHA's Dia de los Muertos altar honored Mountain View pioneers and departed leaders of the association.



Mariachi Tapatio performs inside the Adobe Building.



Younger dancers wore elaborate Dia de los Muertos face paint.



Mariachi Tapatio started their performance in the garden. As the sun went down and November's chill set-in, everyone moved into the cozy, fireplace-warmed Adobe Building.



Fresh pan dulce (Mexican sweet bread) was enjoyed by all!

Special Feature

Heritage Park's Windmill

By Candace Bowers
MVHA Vice President

Windmills and water tanks were once a common sight around Mountain View, even downtown. The windmill would power a pump that drew water from an underground source, and that water would be stored in a tank high above ground, where the force of gravity would then allow it to flow downward to serve as indoor and outdoor plumbing. One such windmill is on display at Heritage Park on Rengstorff Avenue, and it has a special local provenance.

Until recently, the windmill stood on the Gabler property on San Leandro Avenue. In 1930, Karl and Emilie Gabler bought two adjoining one-acre lots in the "Terra Bella Acres" tract. They had emigrated from Germany—Karl in 1928 (age 18) and Emilie in 1929 (age 21). They lived in San Francisco, but would come down on weekends to work on the house. Much of the construction material came from Symon Brothers Wreckers Building Materials in San Francisco. Karl bought the windmill in 1936 from the Geo. W. Sohler & Son Company at 550 California Street. It was made by Flint & Walling Manufacturing Co. in Kendallville, Indiana—the company name is still visible on the vane.

The windmill pumped water to a large storage tank on top of the Gablers' house. The tank was the sole source of water for the house, the vegetable garden, the chickens and goats, and an orchard of 62 fruit and nut trees. When the tank overflowed, water could be heard running down the gutters; Emilie would hurry outside to turn off the windmill.

The windmill was in operation until 1984, when the City installed water and sewer service to the property. The Gabler house has remained in the family; the windmill was given to the City by Carol (Gabler) Garliepp, Carl Gabler, and Jon Garliepp, and was relocated to Heritage Park in 2016.



Photo of the Windmill c. 1937



Photo of the Windmill c. 1980. The manufacturer's name is visible on the windmill.



The windmill today at Heritage Park, with Immigrant House in the foreground.

Membership

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Below are some immediate needs:

History Center: Help us share our historic archives with the public at the library.

Board Positions: We have immediate openings to fill on our Board! Our Board meets only four times a year, so the time commitment is small, but the impact is huge! Interested? Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.



RENEW TODAY

If you had an Annual Membership in 2017, we hope you'll join us again in 2018. Dues are tax deductible to the extent allowed by law. NOTE: For new members who joined after May 2017, your membership carries forward through 2018. Thank you to all our members!

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
Membership Chair

Sorry, due to a recent family emergency I have not been able to update our membership numbers. Thank you to everyone who has renewed for another year or has joined us for a lifetime.

If you missed our last newsletter, here are the most recent membership numbers I have:

Membership as of October 11, 2017

Honored Members	1
Life Members	112
Family Members	60
Single Members	61
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**234**

Thank you all for your membership and support!

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

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☐ Email (full color, save paper!) ☐ Mail (black & white)

WINTER / SPRING

February 11
Sunday, 1:00–3:00 p.m.
MVHA Winter Event & Meeting
The Adobe Building–157 Moffett Blvd.
See details on Page 4

March 7
Wednesday, 6:00–7:30 p.m.
MVHA Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center–585 Franklin St.
Members interested in helping shape future events/projects are encouraged to attend!

May 6
Sunday, 1:00–3:00 p.m.
MVHA Spring Event & Meeting
Adobe Building–157 Moffett Blvd.
Details in our Spring Newsletter!



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